



The Digital World

A Round-up of Technology News from Across the Globe

UNITED STATES

James Vernon Allridge, sentenced to death for shooting a Texas store clerk, has been running a Web site that sells art and greeting cards online. His star customer: Actress Susan Sarandon. He claims he wants to give something constructive back to society.



SWEDEN

Pastor Helge Fossmo has been jailed for life for faking SMS messages from God to get his nanny-lover to murder his wife and try to kill the husband of his second mistress. He was having an affair with the nanny and the neighbour's wife.



JAPAN

Microsoft has launched Japan's first blogging service. With this, Microsoft aims to attract more than one million users in the first year. Google better watch out: the competition just got hotter.



UNITED KINGDOM

Britain has the worst recycling records in Europe. How do we know? Maxitech, a UK-based NGO, has claimed that up to two million working Pentium PCs are dumped in landfill sites in the UK every year. They obviously haven't heard of kabadiwallas.



CHINA

Yahoo! has given China something that it has never given anybody else—a 1 GB free email inbox. While other Asian countries are not so lucky, this move is seen as competition to Google's Gmail in the world's largest emerging market.



AUSTRALIA

Legal experts here have decided that copying music to the Apple iPod is illegal. The reason: Australia does not have a copyright law for fair copying of music, leaving the 1 lakh-odd iPod buyers as potential convicts. History has come full circle, for sure!



Three Incredibly Useful Sites

Academic and Career Guidance

educationinfoindia



www.educationinfoindia.com

This is one Web site you just have to hit. Right from aptitude tests to model test papers to loan information, this Web site has it all. Educationinfoindia.com also has counsellors providing career advice via chat sessions between 11 am to 1 pm IST.

Youngbuzz



www.Youngbuzz.com

Neatly classified data helps you make your career choice. Its Careers section lists every detail about computer engineering, photography, biochemistry, microbiology, etc. Those interested in pursuing careers abroad may hop to its Study Abroad section that answers such queries.

indiaEducation



www.indiaEducation.info

Career counselling, self evaluation, career options, advice for students just clearing their 12th std. exams and a whole bundle of useful sections are found in one major box on the homepage. Information about distance education, vocational education and correspondence courses are smartly packed under the Other Avenues section.

clues, gave Parson away. He was arrested on August 29, last year.

Parson, in court, admitted "intentionally causing damage to a protected computer" before a federal judge in Seattle, as part of a plea bargaining arrangement. He faces between 18 and 37 months in jail, instead of a maximum of ten years. He may also be ordered to pay a fine, which could run into millions of dollars, according to Assistant US Attorney Annette Hayes.

Why the reduced sentence? Parson's Blaster-B hit nothing like a million computers—just about 48,000. In his plea agreement, Parson admitted using Blaster-B to commandeer 50 computers, which he then used to launch a broader attack on the 48,000 computers, a Reuters said.

Parson is what is known in hacker circles as a script kiddie. According to Webopedia.com, a script kiddie is "a person, normally someone who is not technologically sophisticated, who

randomly seeks out a specific weakness over the Internet in order to gain root access to a system without really understanding what it is s/he is exploiting because the weakness was discovered by someone else."

TURN THAT COMP OFF!

Off or On?

You have probably often wondered whether it is better to leave your computer on all the time, or to shut it down once you are done. If you leave your PC on all the time, how much energy are you actually wasting?

Researchers at the University of Waterloo in Canada tried to answer this big question with some interesting tests. They found that PCs with Pentium 4 processors running at 1.7 gigahertz drew 110 watts while booting up, and 60 watts when they were on and idle. A 17-inch CRT monitor added an additional